



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Regents Classical School
School Website: <https://www.regentschattanooga.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Regents Classical School Chattanooga (ZIP 37411) presents a partial alignment with classical education. The public materials clearly place a religious (Christian) foundation at the core of its identity, with explicit language like "Raising up citizens of the City of God" and "grounded in Christian faith." This signals a theological grounding and formation-oriented aim, which aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose & Goal categories of the classical rubric. The site also emphasizes a classical branding (e.g., "Classical Education" and community-oriented initiatives like Family Nights and Community Engagement), and it advertises guidance counseling and family involvement, suggesting collaboration with parents and a broader community.

However, the site does not provide explicit evidence of several core classical curriculum and pedagogy components that the Six Essential Elements articulate (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation orientation, grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, explicit Socratic pedagogy in the upper grades, or a living curriculum with a detailed, classical teacher portrait). In short, Regents shows clear virtue-oriented formation, religious grounding, and community engagement, but it stops short of the full, explicit classical curriculum and pedagogy signals described in the knowledge base. Based on category-by-category signals, the school lands in a balanced, but not fully Classical, position.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle section follows after the category-by-category snapshots.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize a Christian foundation: "Raising up citizens of the City of God" and "grounded in Christian faith."
 - The site frames education in terms of purpose and virtue within a Christian context, signaling a theological grounding.
 - The explicit phrase City of God indicates theological/theosophical orientation within the school's mission.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: Christian faith, Theology-related framing (implicit via "City of God" and "grounded in Christian faith"). Estimated occurrences: 2–3 positive signals.
 - Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no explicit signaling of secular humanism or values-neutral education). No clear negative signals detected.
- Why this rating
 - The materials reflect transcendence-leaning orientation (theology, sacred framing) and communal worship/identity through a Christian worldview, which aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in spirit, though not all explicit sub-elements (e.g., liturgical practices) are foregrounded in the publicly visible pages. The alignment is strong in theology and moral framing

but lacks explicit liturgical or transhistorical ritual language beyond the City of God motif. See evidence above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school articulates a life of purpose through wisdom and eloquence, grounded in Christian faith. This emphasizes formation, virtue, and telos rather than solely career-readiness.
 - The language foregrounds purpose and wisdom, suggesting a classical orientation toward formation and human excellence.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: purpose, wisdom, eloquence, telos (implied by “life of purpose through wisdom and eloquence”); formation/virtue framing is present though not always written as “virtue” explicitly in the pages observed. Estimated occurrences: 3–4 positive signals.
 - Negative keywords: None indicating workforce-readiness or purely utilitarian aims; the emphasis is on formation and character.
- Why this rating
 - The alignment with formation, virtue, and telos is solid, and the Christian grounding reinforces a purposeful, virtuous aim. The absence of explicit “Great Books” or formal liberal-arts framing in the public content keeps this category from fully classical, but the formation-focused and teleological language yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site repeatedly references “Classical Education,” but does not publicly enumerate the core classical curriculum elements (e.g., grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek; history as Western civilization; and other typical liberal-arts anchors). The visible content emphasizes identity, community, and program summaries rather than a detailed liberal-arts sequence.
 - There is no explicit listing of Great Books, Great Conversation, or a graded sequence built on grammar–logic–rhetoric within the accessible pages. The lack of explicit curricular architecture is noticeable when evaluated against the Six Elements criteria.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: “Classical Education” (branding) and “Classical Education Meeting” (visibility of classical orientation). However, these are branding signals rather than explicit curricular commitments. Estimated occurrences: 2 positive signals.
 - Negative keywords present: None explicit on the site; however, absence of explicit Great Books, grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, or explicit liberal-arts curriculum signals contributes to a NOT CLASSICAL designation for this category.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials do not spell out the specific liberal-arts curriculum—grammar, logic, rhetoric—nor the Great Books/western canon emphasis. Without explicit articulation of these components, this category does not meet the core curricular signals. The ranking is NOT CLASSICAL under the strict rubric, though the branding acknowledges classical education.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The visible pages show program and community orientations but do not present explicit pedagogical methods such as Socratic seminars, scholé, or classical memory/narration curricula. There is no explicit multi-year pedagogy described (e.g., upper-grade Socratic dialogue, rhetoric training). The public content focuses on programs and events rather than method.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: None explicitly shown in the observed content. The presence of “Socratic,” “memory work,” “recitation,” or “narration” terms is not evident in the public materials provided. Estimated occurrences: 0.

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- Negative keywords: None explicitly; the absence of classical pedagogy signals translates to NOT CLASSICAL in this category.
 - Why this rating
 - Without explicit signals of Socratic discussion, scholé-based practice, or other classical pedagogy markers beyond branding, this category does not meet the core teaching-method criteria. The current public content signals more about branding and programmatic highlights than detailed pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The materials reference “Instructors” and counselors (e.g., Guidance Counseling), but there is no explicit articulation of a “living curriculum,” model teacher portraits, or a formal “faculty as the living curriculum” ethos in the accessible public content. The presence of staff roles is noted, but not the classical faculty profile language described in the Six Elements.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: None clearly matched from the classical faculty signals (e.g., “model teachers,” “portrait of the teacher,” “faculty of friends”). The site mentions instructors and counselors, but not the cultivated teacher-identity language.
 - Negative keywords: None explicitly; however the absence of the living-curriculum/built-in-model-teacher language yields a NOT CLASSICAL signal for this category.
- Why this rating
 - The school does not publicly present a classical-faculty ethos (as described in the Six Elements) beyond generic staff descriptions. The category therefore lands as NOT CLASSICAL in this dataset.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site features Family Nights, Community Engagement, and open-communication channels (Guidance Counseling, events), signaling partnership with families and parental involvement. Examples include Family Nights and Community Engagement references.
 - The presence of “Understanding the Regents of Chattanooga Initiative” and public-facing events indicates efforts to educate and involve parents, which aligns with the Six Elements’ emphasis on partnership with families and parent formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: Partnership with families, family involvement, parent formation, community engagement, open campus (where applicable). Observed terms include “Family Nights,” “Community Engagement,” and “Guidance Counseling” signaling parental/guardian involvement. Estimated occurrences: 3–4 positive signals.
 - Negative keywords: None clearly observed; there is no obvious framing of parents as customers or minimal involvement.
- Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates observable parent/community engagement signals, aligning with the Six Elements’ emphasis on partnership with families and community formation. The level of explicit “parent formation” content (e.g., book studies, structured parent programs) is not fully spelled out, but the presence of family-oriented events and partnership language justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification here.

Aggregate assessment

- Classical: 0
- Somewhat Classical: 3 (Categories 1, 2, 6)
- Not Classical: 3 (Categories 3, 4, 5)

Overall, the Regents Classical School Chattanooga materials show meaningful alignment with classical principles in a Christian formation context, but fall short of the full, explicit classical curriculum and pedagogy

signals described in the classical rubric. Given the balance of signals, the school is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Expand explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitment and curriculum details, including a stated sequence of liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and key classical texts.
- Publicly articulate a concrete classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars in upper grades, memory work, recitation, dialectic practice) and a plan for the “living curriculum” with a teacher-professional portrait that aligns with the Six Elements.
- Include explicit references to liturgical or communal practices that connect with the religious foundations (e.g., liturgical rhythm, sacred music, communal prayer) to strengthen Element 1 alignment.
- Provide a formal Parent Formation program (book studies, seminar series) with clear schedules and outcomes to intensify and document the Parents & Community alignment in Element 6.
- Publish a detailed curriculum map or annual plan that shows history instruction across the curriculum, including Western civilization and Great Books integration, to move Element 3 toward NOT or closer to Classical.
- Elevate explicit signals of virtuous-mentor faculty presence (e.g., portraits of the teacher, teacher-student mentorship language) to strengthen Element 5.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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